

Strictly confidential

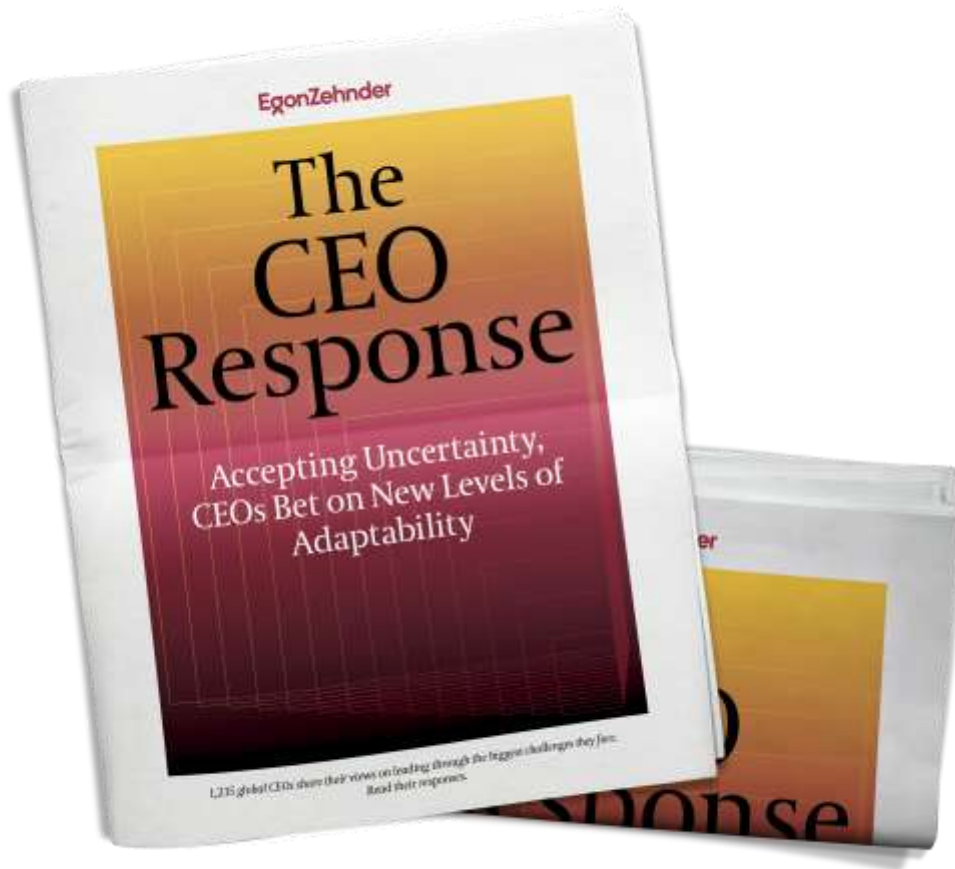
Your Personal Report

The CEO Response

Accepting Uncertainty, CEOs Bet on New Levels of Adaptability

1,235 global CEOs share their views on leading through the biggest challenges they face.

EgonZehnder



Dear CEO

Thank you for participating in the CEO Response survey, we highly value your input. Your personalized report is now available and shared with you confidentially, highlighting key findings and how your responses compare to your peers.

CEOs worldwide are navigating unprecedented complexity and redefining leadership. Insights from 1,235 peers reveal a decisive shift: adaptability and agility are now essential. This year, 92% agree they must cultivate adaptability beyond anything previously imagined—within themselves and their teams.

They are moving beyond scripted approaches, embracing innovation, and investing in talent to navigate uncertainty. While 72% anticipate stagnating global prosperity, nearly all see opportunities to drive impact—anchoring growth locally, leveraging AI, and building resilience. Despite mounting challenges, CEOs are responding with confidence—transforming organizations and, in many ways, the world.

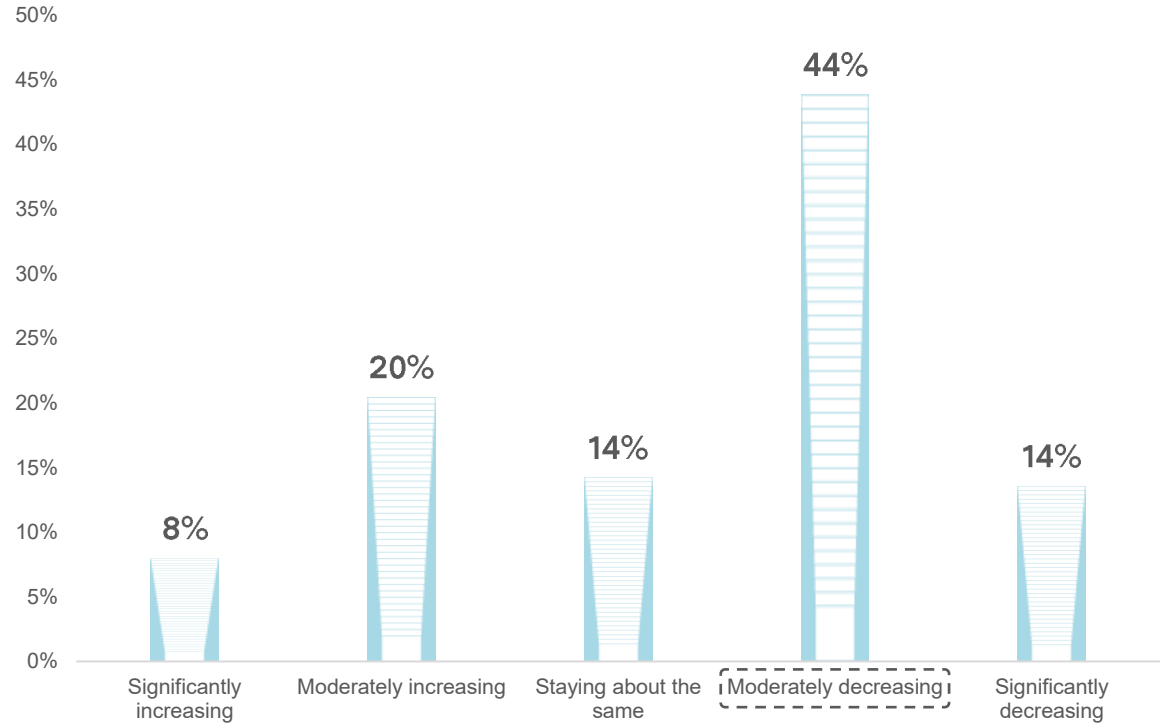
We hope these findings—and your comparison to peers—spark reflection as CEOs lead through uncertainty, prioritizing transformation with curiosity, purpose, and strategic impact.

We'd welcome the opportunity to hear what resonates most with you from the report. If you'd like to explore how these insights relate to your priorities and leadership agenda, feel free to reach out at: CEOSurvey@egonzehnder.com

Your Egon Zehnder Team

As change and complexity accelerate, are the prospects for global prosperity in a multipolar world increasing or decreasing, in your opinion?

For most CEOs, the prospects for global prosperity are decreasing or stagnating—though some are slightly more optimistic.



In your view, should business leaders play a role in shaping a prosperous global order?
Please select the statement that best reflects your perspective:

**Almost all CEOs
recognize possibilities
for contributing to global
prosperity in the future,
either within or outside
their organizations.**

40%

Yes, business leaders have a responsibility to help shape global prosperity and stability by engaging outside of their business.

32%

Business leaders can support global Prosperity and stability indirectly, within their own operations.

25%

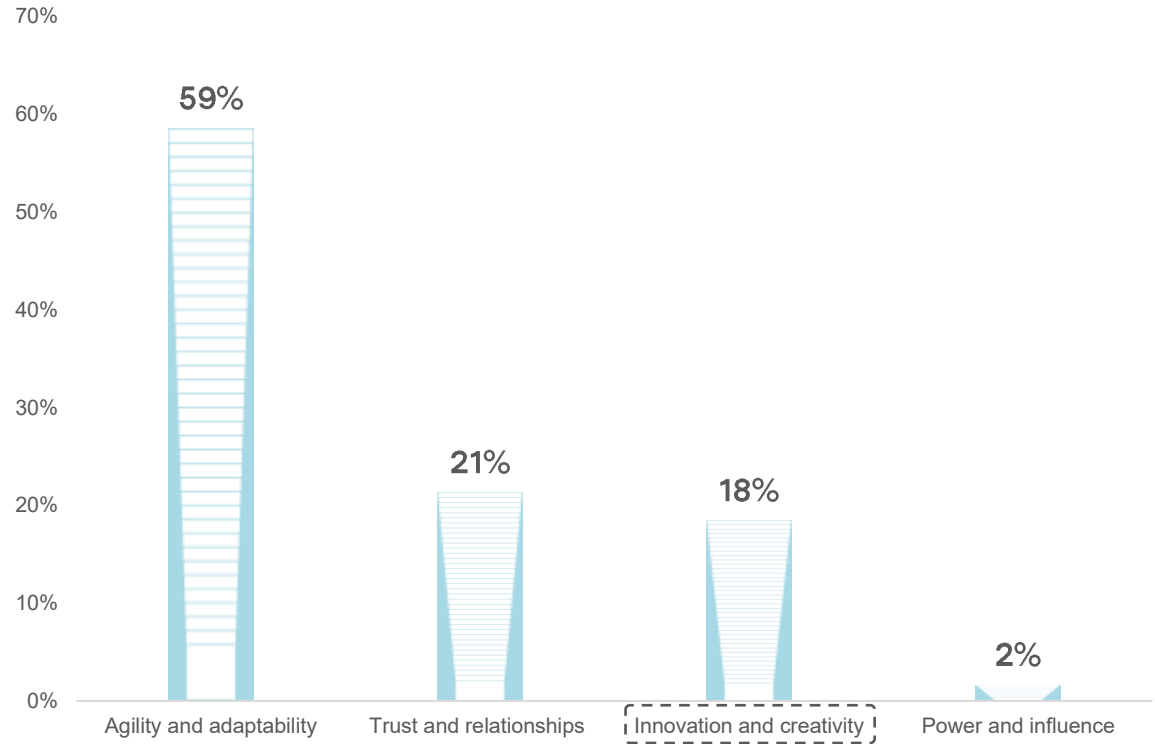
Business leaders may contribute to global prosperity and stability, but leaders' main responsibility is to shareholders and financial performance.

3%

No, business leaders should not be expected to play a role in shaping global order; this is the domain of governments and international institutions.

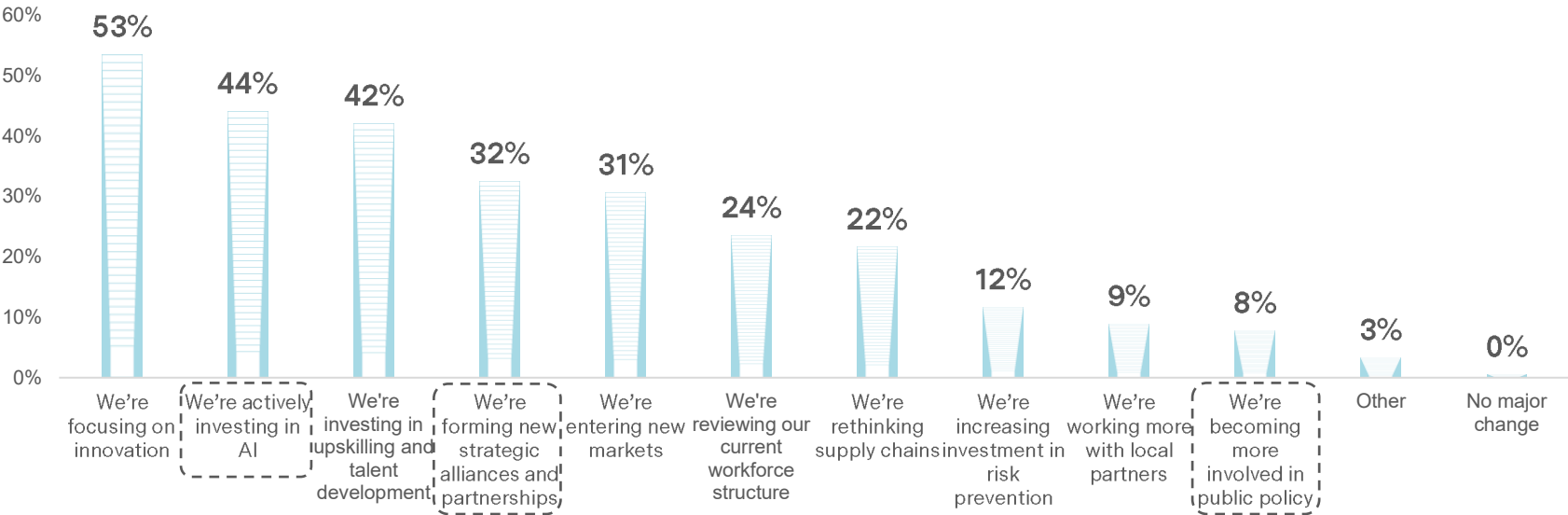
In today's world, what is the most important currency for business success among the options below?

There is no question that CEOs see agility and adaptability as their key resources for business success in the current environment.



What major changes are you implementing to ensure prosperity for your organization in an increasingly multipolar world? Please select your top three.

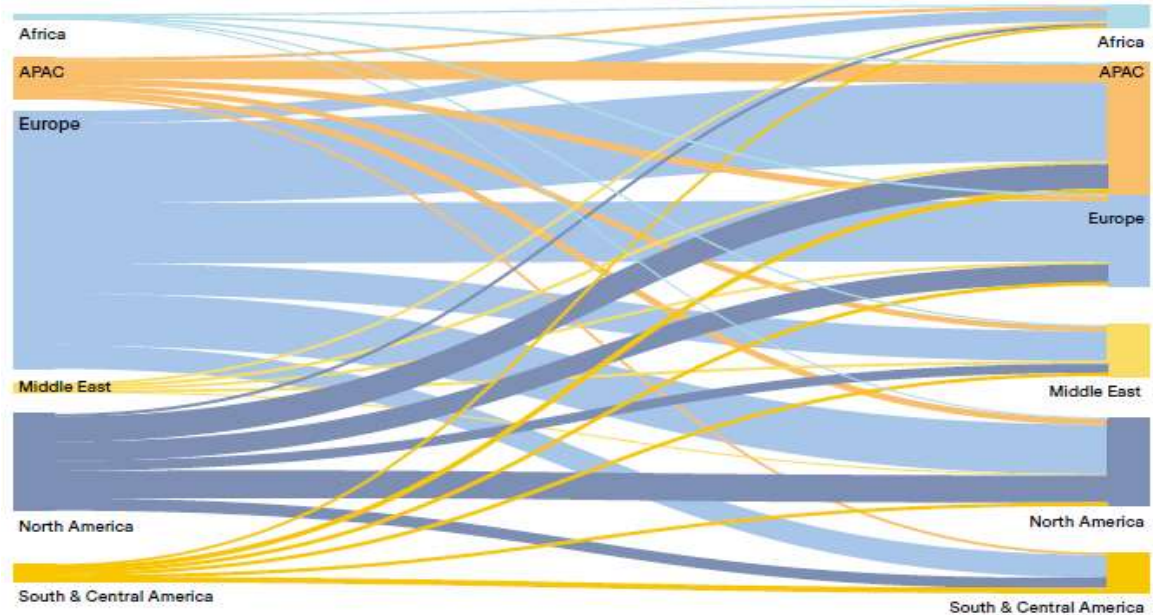
To advance growth, the top three areas CEOs are prioritizing are Innovation (53%), AI Investment (44%), and Talent Development (42%).



Which locations do you believe hold the most promise for establishing new business partnerships in the emerging multipolar world? Select all that apply:

In an atmosphere of such widespread geopolitical instability, CEOs show a tendency to foresee the most promising new partnerships both in their own regions as well as the APAC region.

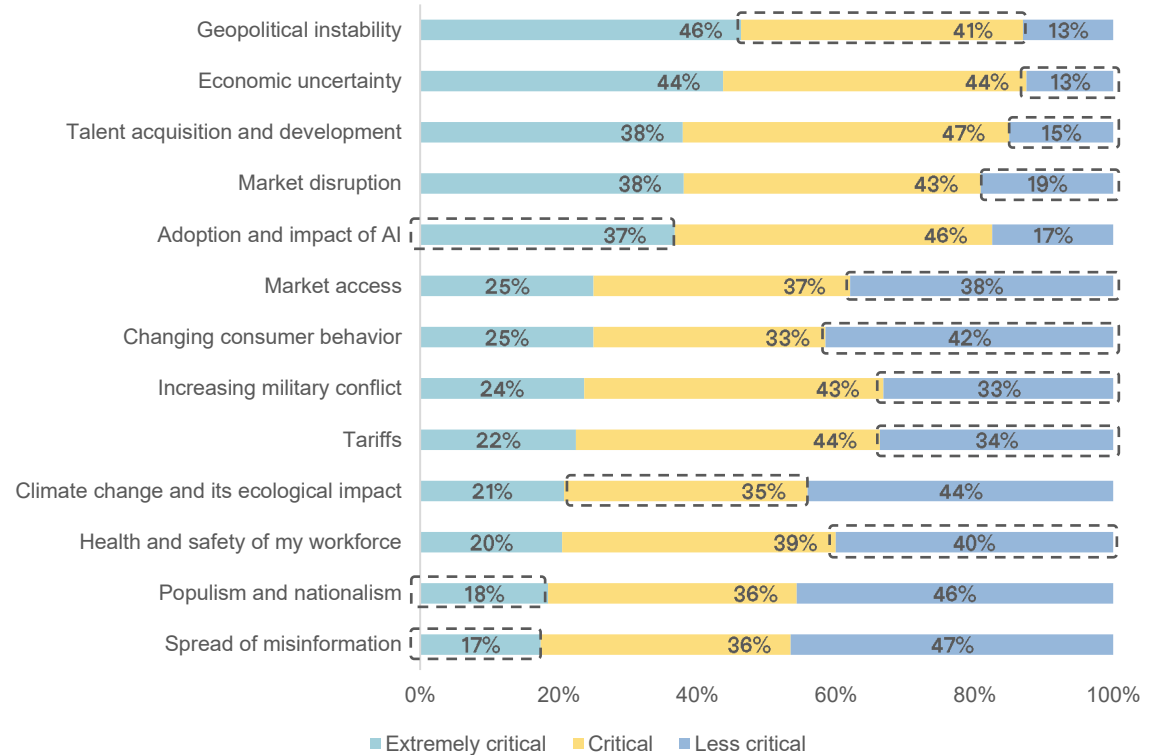
CEOs from...



see promise building partnerships in...

How critical are the following challenges for your organization? Please sort the items into the respective boxes. (Existentially critical, critical, less critical)

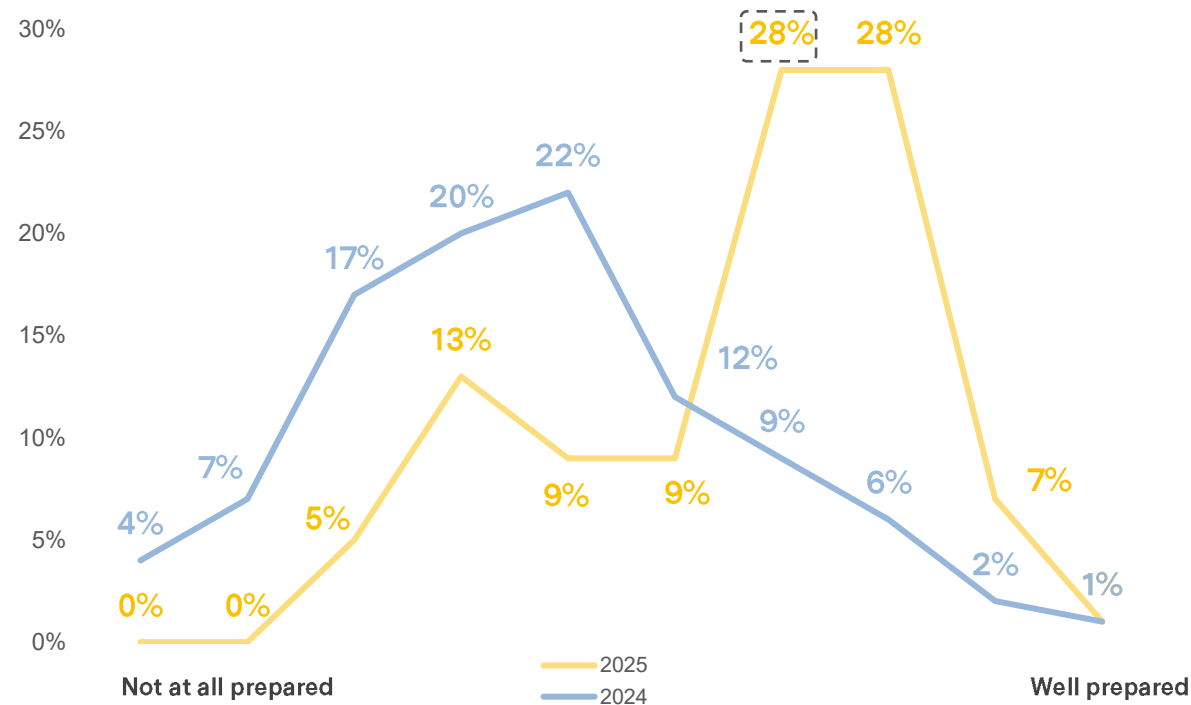
In an environment that is critically charged, CEOs identify geopolitical instability as their most extreme challenge. Economic uncertainty, market disruption, talent development, and the adoption and impact of AI are extremely pressing as well.



= Your Response

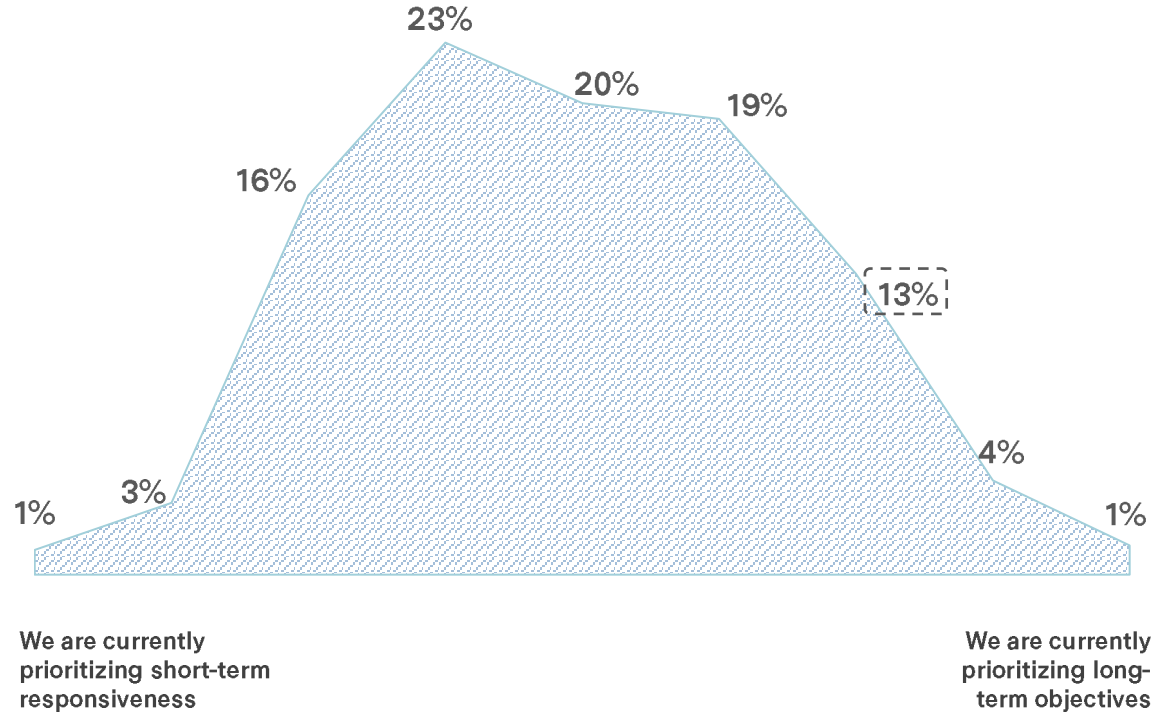
Thinking about the challenges you indicated as critical, how prepared is your organization to face the inherent complexity?

CEOs are dramatically more prepared for the expected complexity ahead compared to last year.



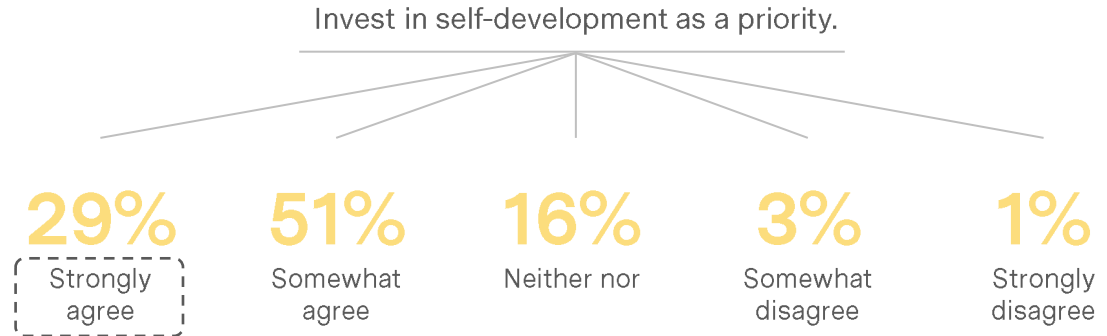
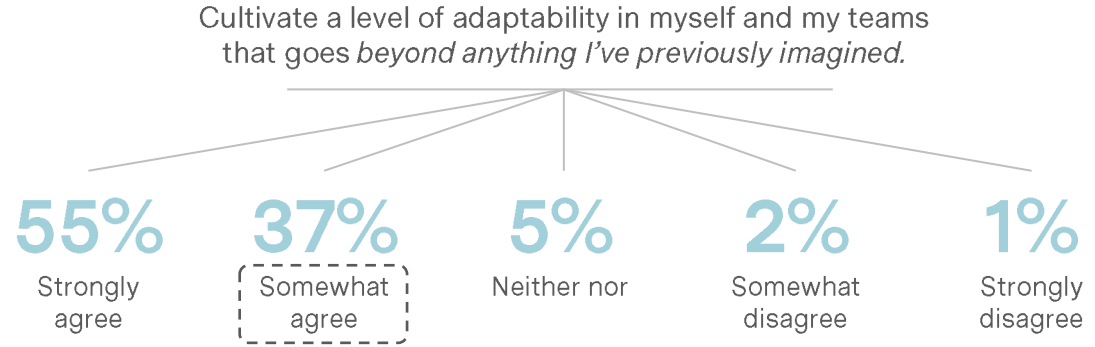
How are you currently balancing short-term responsiveness and long-term objectives?

In such a disruptive environment, CEOs see short- and long-term objectives as a continuous balancing act, with the short-term taking precedence.



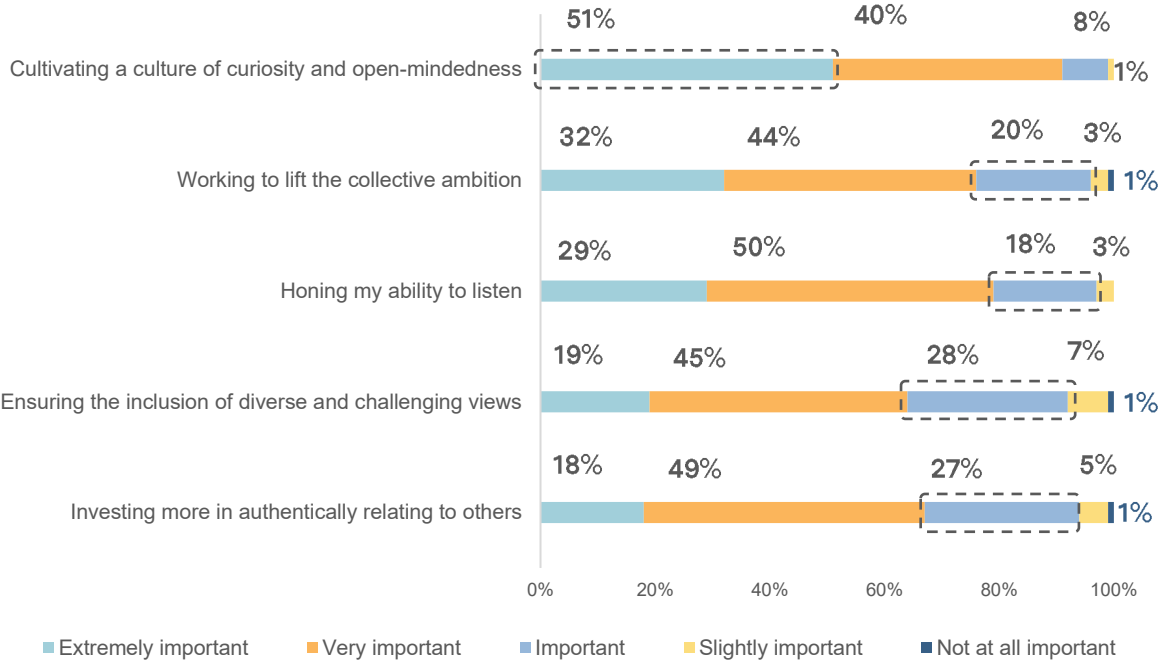
To what extent do you agree with these statements:
As CEO, leading through unpredictable times, I need to...

An overwhelming majority of CEOs (93%) acknowledge that they must cultivate levels of adaptability that go beyond anything previously imagined.



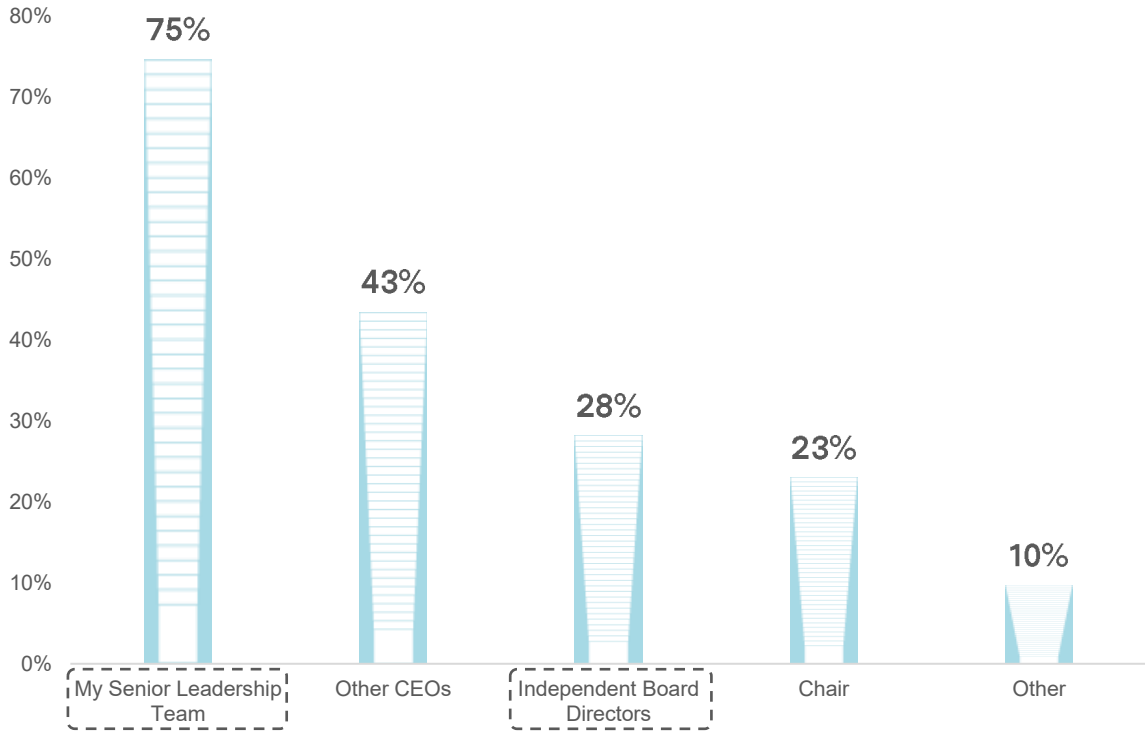
How important are the following for you to successfully master the challenges of today's complexity?

There's a clear consensus that cultivating a culture of curiosity and open-mindedness is the key leadership skill for today's complexity.



Who is or are your best resources for discussing and making sense of the challenges ahead? Select all that apply

Most CEOs are turning first and foremost to their executive teams and then their peers as sparring partners to make sense of the many challenges they are facing.



Participants

Is this your first CEO role?



Are you or have you been a Group CEO?



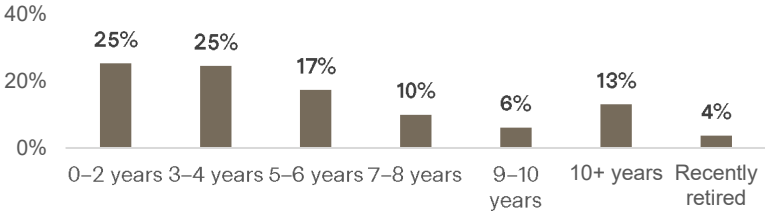
Were you internally promoted or externally hired into your current role?



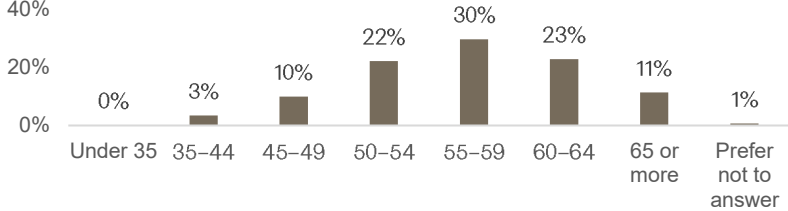
Gender you most identify with:



How long have you been in your current role?

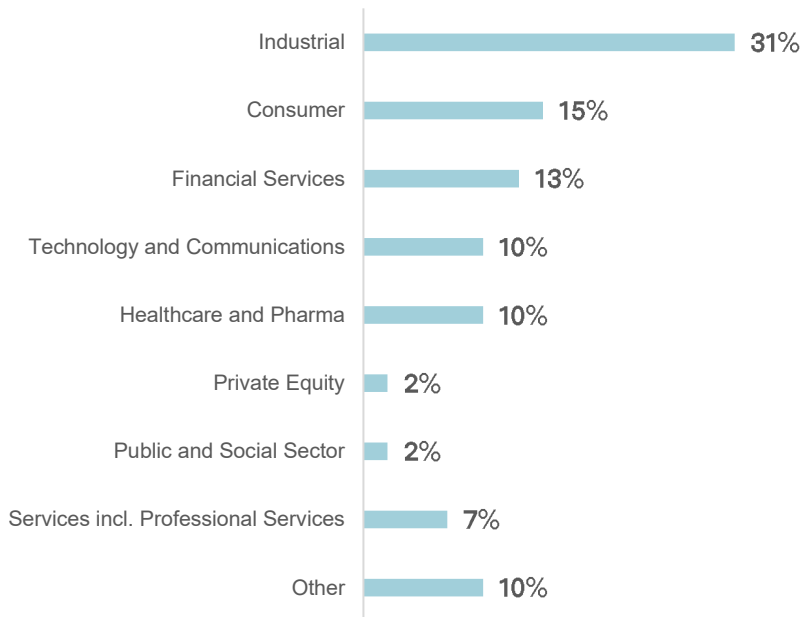


What is your age?

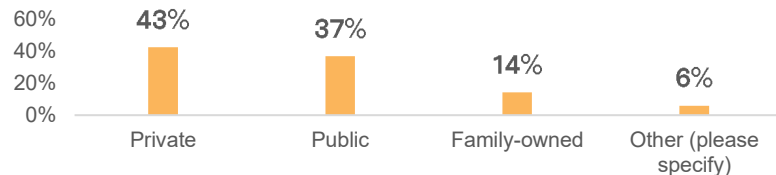


Organizations

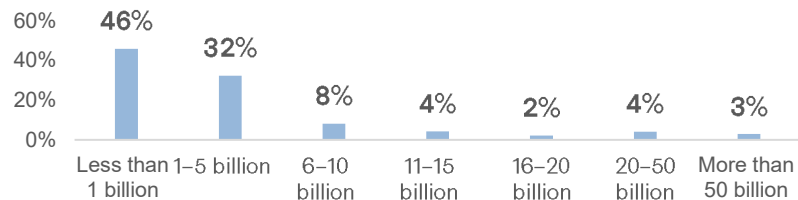
Which of the following represents the main activity of your organization (i.e., accounts for the largest proportion of revenue)?



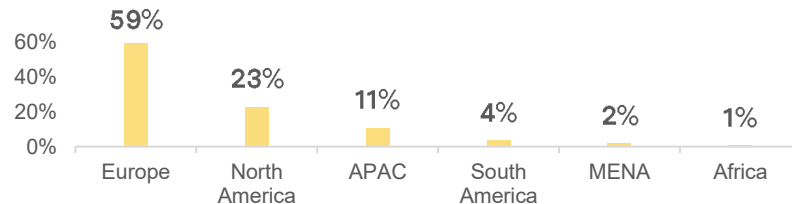
What is your company's ownership structure?



What is your company's revenue?



Where is your office based?



Thank you

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